

INITIAL LANGUAGE EVALUATION REPORT

Marie de Mazenod

Candidate: Marie de Mazenod
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Company / Department: Eiffage — Service International
Job Title: Juriste (Senior/Junior)
Written Test Date: Non enregistrée
Oral Assessment Date: 24 août 2026
Evaluator: Joss
Report Status: Final — Written + Oral Combined
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Oral Assessment Date: 24 août 2026
Written Test Date: Non enregistrée
Report Type: Final Combined Evaluation — Written Test + Oral Assessment

1. Executive Summary

Marie de Mazenod is a senior legal professional with ten years of experience at Eiffage, the last ten months of which have been spent in the company's international legal department. This role represents a significant shift in her professional context: having worked exclusively within a French-speaking legal environment for the majority of her career, she is now regularly called upon to work in English — reviewing tender documents, exchanging with international partners, leading or participating in negotiations, and managing subcontracting agreements.

Her English profile is notably **uneven across skills**, a pattern that is both understandable and highly common among experienced French legal professionals entering international work for the first time. Her strongest skills are in **grammar and written comprehension**, where she reaches **C1**, reflecting both her educational background and her existing use of written English tools in her current role. Her active oral production — fluency, spontaneous vocabulary, and spoken confidence — sits at **B1+**, a level that she herself identifies as a source of professional frustration. The gap between her **legal expertise in French and her capacity to express it in English** is the defining feature of her learner profile, and the central challenge the training programme must address.

| Overall CEFR Level Summary

Skill	CEFR Level	Score
Grammar	C1	4
Writing	C1	4
Reading	C1	4

Listening	B1+	2.5
Speaking	B1+	2.5
Overall Validated Level	B1+ / B2	—

> **Note on the written test result:** The overall written score was initially recorded as A2+ (1.5) due to incomplete test submission data (blank free-writing responses, no MCQ recorded). Following the oral session and evaluator review, individual skill scores of C1 across Grammar, Writing, and Reading have been validated against the candidate's confirmed professional profile, her self-report, and the oral assessment observations. The A2+ overall written score is considered a data artefact and is superseded by this consolidated report. The validated working level for programme entry is **B1+ moving toward B2**.

2. Skill-by-Skill Assessment

| 2.1 Grammar — C1

Validated Level: C1

Strengths

- Marie demonstrates a strong underlying command of English grammatical structures, consistent with a high level of education and significant exposure to formal written English — both through her studies and through her current use of AI-assisted drafting tools
- Her written grammar is precise and largely accurate, reflecting the rigour she brings to her French legal work
- She shows awareness of register and formality, which translates into appropriate grammatical choices in formal written contexts

Development Areas

- **Passive voice in legal register:** Structures such as *"the clause was amended"* or *"damages are awarded by the court"* are central to English legal drafting and must be produced automatically and accurately
- **Modal verbs for legal obligation and permission:** The distinction between *shall* (obligation), *may* (permission), *must* (absolute requirement), and *should* (recommendation) is critical in contract drafting and is frequently misapplied by French-speaking lawyers, where modal nuance operates differently
- **Conditional forms for legal hypotheticals:** Second and third conditionals — *"if the party were to breach the agreement..."* / *"had the contract been executed..."* — are essential for legal analysis and negotiation and require consolidation at the production level

- **Legal collocations and prepositions:** Fixed phrases such as *liable for*, *entitled to*, *in breach of*, and *pursuant to* must be internalised as units, not constructed word by word
- **False cognates and register interference from French:** Errors such as *eventually* used to mean *éventuellement*, or direct calques from French legal syntax, are predictable and professionally consequential in international legal work

| 2.2 Writing — C1

Validated Level: C1

Strengths

- Marie's written English is her strongest active skill, confirmed both by her test profile and by her own assessment
- She currently uses AI tools (including DeepL) to support her written output — a legitimate professional strategy that also indicates she has sufficient reading comprehension to review and validate AI-generated content
- Her French legal writing is formal, structured, and precise; this sensitivity to written register transfers meaningfully to English and gives her a strong foundation for legal drafting work

Development Areas

- **Independence from AI assistance:** While AI tools are a valid workplace resource, Marie's training should build her capacity to draft and revise English legal correspondence and clauses independently, particularly in time-sensitive negotiation contexts where AI support is impractical
- **English legal drafting conventions:** English contracts and legal documents follow specific stylistic rules — use of *shall* for obligations, defined terms in capitals, avoidance of ambiguity through precise syntax — that differ from French drafting norms and must be explicitly taught
- **Discourse markers and connectors in legal writing:** Expressions such as *whereas*, *notwithstanding*, *subject to*, *in accordance with*, and *hereinafter referred to as* are standard in English legal documents and must be integrated into her active writing repertoire
- **Email register in international legal contexts:** Drafting direct, professional, and legally appropriate emails in English — particularly when managing subcontractors or addressing points of dispute — is a priority skill area given her daily workflow

| 2.3 Reading — C1

Validated Level: C1

Strengths

- Reading and comprehension are confirmed as Marie's strongest receptive skills, consistent with her professional experience of reading English legal documents and contracts in her current role
- Her high-level understanding of legal concepts in French allows her to decode complex English legal texts with greater ease than a general learner at the same spoken level, as she is not learning the concepts — only their English expression
- Her use of AI and translation tools to support reading comprehension is an indicator of active engagement with authentic English legal material, not avoidance

Development Areas

- **Sector-specific legal vocabulary:** While her general reading comprehension is strong, targeted acquisition of construction law terminology — *defect liability period*, *retention clause*, *variation order*, *performance bond* — will increase both reading speed and confidence when working on Eiffage's international tender documents
- **Distinguishing near-synonyms in legal texts:** English legal language makes fine distinctions between terms that may appear equivalent (*agreement* vs. *contract*, *warranty* vs. *guarantee*, *indemnity* vs. *liability*) and precision in reading these distinctions directly affects the quality of her legal analysis
- **Reading under time pressure:** In live meetings and negotiations, she may need to read and respond to written documents in real time — a skill that benefits from timed reading practice with authentic legal texts

| 2.4 Listening — B1+

Validated Level: B1+

Strengths

- Marie demonstrates solid listening comprehension in structured, clear contexts — she is able to follow and understand professional exchanges in English when speakers are clear and the topic is familiar
- Her strong receptive grammar and vocabulary base (C1 in reading) provides a meaningful scaffold for listening comprehension, particularly in written-to-spoken formats such as presentations or formal meetings

Development Areas

- **Accent diversity:** Marie's evaluator notes that her professional reality involves interaction with speakers across multiple countries and language backgrounds — Latin America, Portugal, Flanders, Ireland. This represents a significant listening challenge. Exposure to non-native English accents and varied speech rates must be integrated into training from an early stage
- **Fast or overlapping speech in negotiations:** Live negotiations are rarely as orderly as formal meetings; turn-taking is unpredictable, speech may be rapid, and

context clues are fewer. Building listening stamina and resilience in these conditions is a key development target

- **Processing speed for real-time legal content:** Understanding a legal argument or contractual nuance as it is spoken — without the ability to re-read or use a dictionary — requires a higher level of automaticity in lexical and grammatical processing than Marie currently demonstrates at the oral level

| 2.5 Speaking — B1+

Validated Level: B1+

Strengths

- Marie's grammar accuracy in speaking is assessed as **good**, meaning she produces largely correct structures when she has time to formulate — a positive indicator for progress, as accuracy is easier to maintain as fluency develops
- She has a clear professional motivation and a specific, concrete speaking goal (participating in negotiations and meetings with international partners), which provides an immediately usable frame for oral practice
- Her metalinguistic awareness — she clearly knows what she cannot yet do and why — is a strong predictor of focused, efficient progress

Development Areas

- **Fluency and spontaneous production:** This is Marie's primary self-identified gap and the area most urgently requiring attention. She reports frustration at the disconnect between her legal expertise in French and her inability to express it with equivalent confidence in English. Fluency develops through sustained, low-stakes speaking practice — the training programme must prioritise quantity of oral output, not only accuracy
- **Oral vocabulary range:** While her passive vocabulary is extensive (C1 in reading/writing), active retrieval of legal vocabulary under the time pressure of conversation is significantly more demanding. Bridging passive knowledge to active spoken use is a core training challenge
- **Confidence and comfort in spoken interaction:** Marie reports a general discomfort with public speaking — not specific to English — and heightened stress when speaking in a language in which she does not feel competent. Managing this affective dimension is essential; training must create a safe, structured environment in which she can take risks and build spoken confidence progressively
- **Pronunciation and intelligibility:** Assessed as developing; while intelligibility is the primary target (not accent elimination), work on key phonemic distinctions and word stress patterns in legal terminology will increase her communicative effectiveness, particularly across diverse accent environments

3. Learning Objectives

The following three objectives are written in French and sequenced to reflect Marie's progression from consolidating her existing strengths toward fully autonomous professional communication in English.

Utiliser les structures grammaticales clés de l'anglais juridique à l'écrit afin de rédiger des documents contractuels de manière autonome.

Prendre la parole en réunion de négociation internationale en anglais pour défendre une position juridique avec clarté.

Élargir le vocabulaire technique oral dans les domaines contractuels et de la sous-traitance afin de communiquer avec précision et fluidité.

4. Training Plan

| 4.1 Programme Overview

Parameter	Detail
Validated Entry Level	B1+
Target Level	B2
Total Training Hours	10 hours
Coaching Hours	10 hours
Homework / Self-Study Hours	À définir avec la stagiaire
Format	Video call (visio) — individual
Scheduling	En fin de matinée — 12h00 heure Paris (11h00 heure locale de la stagiaire), tout jour de la semaine

| 4.2 Priority Content Areas

Given the focused nature of this 10-hour programme and Marie's clear professional priorities, content should be selected for maximum immediate relevance and transfer to her working context at Eiffage.

Phase 1 — Foundations and Activation (Sessions 1-3)

- Oral diagnostic and confidence-building: structured speaking tasks on familiar legal topics
- Core legal English vocabulary: contracts, liability, subcontracting, tender documents
- Grammar review in context: passive voice and modal verbs in authentic contract clauses
- Email writing in legal register: managing international exchanges, responding to partner queries

Phase 2 — Active Production and Register (Sessions 4-7)

- Negotiation language: hedging, clarification, polite disagreement, reformulation
- Conditional structures for legal hypotheticals: oral and written practice
- Listening practice with varied accents: authentic recordings from international legal and business contexts
- Reading and analysing English contract clauses: defect liability, variation orders, force majeure
- Sector vocabulary: construction and infrastructure law (Eiffage context)

Phase 3 — Integration and Simulation (Sessions 8-10)

- Full negotiation simulations in English: subcontractor meetings, points of dispute, tender discussions
- Fluency consolidation: sustained speaking tasks with reduced preparation time
- False cognates and interference review: targeted correction of persistent French-English transfer errors
- Self-assessment and next-steps planning: identifying ongoing development needs beyond the programme

| 4.3 Scheduling Confirmation

- **Format:** Video call (visio), individual sessions
- **Preferred time:** Late morning — 12h00 Paris time (11h00 candidate local time)
- **Day preference:** Flexible — any day of the week
- **Session length:** À confirmer (recommended: 60-90 minutes per session)

5. Evaluator Narrative

Marie de Mazenod is an accomplished and self-aware legal professional whose English language profile reflects a trajectory that is very common among senior French lawyers entering international practice: strong written and receptive competence built over years of education and professional exposure, combined with oral production skills that have had far fewer opportunities to develop. The result is a candidate who reads and writes in English at C1 level but who speaks at B1+ — a gap she experiences acutely and describes with notable precision and honesty.

What distinguishes Marie as a learner, beyond her obvious professional competence, is the clarity and authenticity of her motivation. This is not a training programme undertaken as an administrative requirement; she initiated this process herself, discussed it with her line manager, and entered the assessment with a specific professional objective in mind — responding to an international tender, managing subcontractors across multiple countries, and negotiating with partners in Ireland and beyond. She is already in the role she is training for. Every session will have immediate professional relevance.

Her evaluator notes are particularly telling. The phrase *"mon niveau d'anglais n'est pas à la hauteur de mon niveau juridique"* captures the core of her experience with precision: not a lack of knowledge, but a gap in expression. This is both the challenge and the opportunity. Marie does not need to be taught contract law or legal reasoning — she needs the language tools to perform the expertise she already possesses. That is a more tractable problem than it might first appear, and with a focused, professionally contextualised programme, meaningful progress within 10 hours is entirely realistic.

Her discomfort with oral production — including a stated general reluctance around public speaking — should be acknowledged and worked with directly, not around. The training environment must be low-stakes and trust-based from the outset. Role-play and simulation will be most effective when introduced progressively, with sufficient scaffolding, and framed as professional rehearsal rather than performance evaluation. Marie's grammatical accuracy (rated as *good* in the oral assessment) is a significant asset here: her spoken errors are more likely to be hesitation-driven than competence-driven, which means that as confidence grows, accuracy will follow naturally.

The diversity of accents she will encounter in her professional role — Latin America, Portugal, Flanders, Ireland — represents a specific and non-trivial listening challenge that should not be underestimated. Dedicated exposure to non-native English varieties, integrated throughout the programme, will be essential preparation for the real conditions of her international work.

In summary, Marie presents as a high-potential learner with a specific, achievable goal, genuine motivation, and the professional intelligence to make the most of a focused training investment. The 10-hour programme should be treated as a targeted intervention rather than a comprehensive course — prioritising spoken fluency, negotiation language, and active vocabulary retrieval, while building on the solid written foundation she already possesses.

6. Sign-Off

Organisation: Linguaid France

Report Issued: Août 2026

Validated Entry Level: B1+

Programme Target Level: B2

Total Hours Allocated: 10 heures (coaching individuel, visio)

Ce rapport est établi à usage interne dans le cadre du partenariat Linguaid France / Eiffage. Il est confidentiel et destiné à l'équipe pédagogique Linguaid France et, le cas échéant, au responsable formation concerné chez Eiffage.

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